

Lumbar Artificial Disc Replacement (LADR)

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

150.10

Manual Section Title

Lumbar Artificial Disc Replacement (LADR)

Version Number

2

Effective Date of this Version

08/14/2007

Implementation Date

10/01/2007

Description Information

Benefit Category

Inpatient Hospital Services

Physicians' Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

A. General

The lumbar artificial disc replacement (LADR) is a surgical procedure on the lumbar spine that involves complete removal of the damaged or diseased lumbar intervertebral disc and implantation of an artificial disc. The procedure may be done as an alternative to lumbar spinal fusion and is intended to reduce pain, increase movement at the site of surgery and restore intervertebral disc height. The Food and Drug Administration has approved the use of LADR for spine arthroplasty in skeletally mature patients with degenerative or discogenic disc disease at one level for L3 to S1.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

B. Nationally Covered Indications

N/A

C. Nationally Non-Covered Indications

Effective for services performed from May 16, 2006 through August 13, 2007, the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) has found that LADR with the Charite™ lumbar artificial disc is not reasonable and necessary for the Medicare population over 60 years of age; therefore, LADR with the Charite™ lumbar artificial disc is non-covered for Medicare beneficiaries over 60 years of age.

Effective for services performed on or after August 14, 2007, CMS has found that LADR is not reasonable and necessary for the Medicare population over 60 years of age; therefore, LADR is non-covered for Medicare beneficiaries over 60 years of age.

D. Other

For Medicare beneficiaries 60 years of age and younger, there is no national coverage determination for LADR, leaving such determinations to continue to be made by the local Medicare Administrative Contractors.

For dates of service May 16, 2006 through August 13, 2007, Medicare coverage under the investigational device exemption (IDE) for LADR with a disc other than the Charite™ lumbar disc in eligible clinical trials is not impacted.

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 1340 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

75

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Transmittals/Downloads/R75NCD.pdf> 

Revision History

04/2023 - Transmittal 11884 issued March 01, 2023, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11952, dated, April 12, 2023, to remove the A/B MACs (Part A) and FISS from BR 13070.1 and to revise the NCD 20.4 Implantable Automatic Defibrillators (ICDs) spreadsheet. All other information remains the same. ([TN 11952](#) ) (CR13070)

02/2023 - The purpose of the Change Request (CR) is to provide a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 11832](#) ) (CR13070)

03/2013 - CMS translated the information for this policy from ICD-9-CM/PCS to ICD-10-CM/PCS according to HIPAA standard medical data code set requirements and updated any necessary and related coding infrastructure. These updates do not expand, restrict, or alter existing coverage policy. Implementation date: 10/07/2013 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1199](#)) ([TN 1199](#)) (CR 8197)

09/2007 - Effective date: 08/14/2007. Implementation date: 10/01/2007. ([TN 75](#)) CR5727

06/2006 - Upon completion of a national coverage analysis (NCA) for LADR, the decision was made that LADR with the Charite™ lumbar artificial disc is non-covered for Medicare beneficiaries over 60 years of age. Effective date for Carriers: 07/17/2006 Effective date for FI's: 10/01/2006.([TN 60](#)) CR5057

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Lumbar Artificial Disc Replacement \(CAG-00292N\)](#)
- [First reconsideration for Lumbar Artificial Disc Replacement \(LADR\) \(CAG-00292R\)](#)

Additional Information

Other Versions			
Title	Version	Effective Between	
Lumbar Artificial Disc Replacement (LADR)	2	08/14/2007 - N/A	You are here
Lumbar Artificial Disc Replacement (LADR)	1	05/16/2006 - 08/14/2007	View